Individual Project

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Choose and solve your own problem. No leader/member split.

- **GitHub:** project artifacts — code, tests, docs, and design
- **Canvas:** goals, plans, weekly progress, links, and submissions
- **GitHub Pages:** project portfolio site

Why an Individual Project?

- Engineers need teamwork and independent problem-solving.
- Prove you can choose a problem, design, build, and test independently.
- Start small: Gmail began as a Google engineer's individual project.
- The result becomes a piece of your portfolio.

Choosing a Topic

Solve a daily problem. Build an app you will use.

- Pick a topic that interests you, helps you grow, and makes you proud.
- Examples: **TravelBuddy** (trips and budgets), **TagGPT** (tag and search ChatGPT prompts), **AnkiCode** (flashcards for programming syntax).

Why → What → How, and Taking Risks

- Decide **why**, then **what**; AI can help with **how**.
- Start with what you know; notice useful tools as you work (*Red Car Theory*).
- **Team:** play it safe. **Individual:** take risks and learn.
- The challenge is managing complexity, not typing code.

Project Process

- Same two-sprint cycle and deadline/extension rules as the team project.
- Requirements: why → features → testable requirements → acceptance tests.
- Deliverables (HW2, HW4, final): see Canvas.
- No PPP/S1P/FP ceremonies. Presentation and/or peer evaluation: see Canvas.

Presentation and/or Peer Evaluation

Your course may use either or both (see Canvas).

- **Live presentation:** informal progress checkpoint, not the final deadline.
- **Peer evaluation:** review **three assigned peers'** projects; assignments are confidential.
- GitHub and Canvas artifacts are the evidence.

Documentation Is Your Presentation

Peers learn about your work from GitHub and Canvas.

1. **Write Clearly:** explain the problem, approach, and status.
2. **Show Evidence:** tests and a short demo (screenshots/video).
3. **Keep It Current:** update Canvas weekly.

Evaluation

No team leader: **assigned peers** and/or the professor evaluate GitHub/Canvas artifacts and any presentation, depending on the course.

Check the current Canvas rubric for points and submissions.

What Your Peers Look At

- Planned vs. delivered work
- Sustained weekly progress
- Quality of code, tests, and documentation
- Acceptance-test evidence
- How clearly you documented risks and changes

Plan Ahead and Report Changes

> Last-minute rushing causes late, low-quality work.

1. **Plan Wisely:** target one week before the deadline.
2. **Communicate Early:** report issues and plan changes on Canvas, with reasons and impact.
3. **Update Artifacts:** update affected GitHub files.
4. **Deliver Consistently:** sustained progress is evaluated.

Project Results Can Strengthen Your Portfolio

1. **Prove Capability:** Show real problem-solving skills.
2. **Showcase the Work:** Use a GitHub hub and concise project summary.
3. **Reflect:** Explain what worked, what failed, and what you learned.

Recommendations for Project Success

- Start early and finish early.
- Keep your progress visible — no surprises.
- Focus on growth, not only points.
- Ask for help when you need it.